



Flying again in supersonic?

Supersonic passenger travel has been out of service for ages and it may make its way back <http://dgit.in/PassengerSupersonic>



Removing body fat using Gold

Researchers have developed a method to reduce body fat by injecting gold nanoparticles to melt away the fat <http://dgit.in/GoldToReduceFat>

A chat on Augmented Intelligence

Evernote is so much more than just a note-taking app, and pushing the boundaries of what's possibly the world's most preferred note-taking app is Zeesha Currimbhoy, VP, Augmented Intelligence, Evernote. Equipped with adding a new level of intelligence to the Evernote experience to ensure it stays ahead of the curve isn't as easy as it sounds. Excerpts from our exclusive interview:

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Q We've heard of artificial intelligence. What's augmented intelligence and how's it different?

Zeesha: Artificial intelligence is all about building an artificial human brain, so to speak; building a computer that can do pretty much everything that a human can do. And that's great. But at Evernote, we believe AI stands for something else. It's not artificial but augmented intelligence, because our goal is simple. We believe humans are good at doing certain things and they have unique qualities about them, and we want to retain them. Then there are certain things that computers are really good at too. So we want to combine the two competencies, utilize the computer's ability to compute large amounts of data in very short time and pair that with existing human intelligence. When you combine the two complementary systems and get them to work together, the results are just off the charts, as it's the best of both worlds. Designing a system that learns from your own behaviour, makes you more empowered, that's the kind of impact that we're striving towards with augmented intelligence.

Q How's such a system implemented?

Zeesha: The core implementations of augmented intelligence can span across a number of areas. We do things like rethink search – how people search for information. Make search a natural extension of how someone thinks. That's one of the things we did recently with Descriptive Search



Zeesha Currimbhoy, VP, Augmented Intelligence, Evernote

in Evernote. Another new feature called Related Notes is all about being able to show you the right information at the right time and when you need it the most. If we want Evernote to be the place where people work in and are most productive then Evernote should be able to work on your behalf by retrieving your own information (saved notes) at the right context.

Q Is Evernote's augmented intelligence going to be confined to the app itself or will it shape into an entity similar to Google Now, Siri or Cortana?

Zeesha: I definitely think that that's something that's going to happen soon. Google Now is great and a classic example of predictive intelligence and show you information before you want it. We're definitely thinking along similar lines trying to anticipate what you want but we're very focused on

you, your memories, and your work life. We want to be the place where you're most productive. So the type of information that we'll highlight will be very different. For e.g., let's say you're walking into a meeting and by looking into your notes history, calendar information, etc., we can notify you to read certain notes that we think will be helpful for you in the meeting. Your data in Evernote should work for you just like your brain works – you put something in your brain in the form of memories and just instinctively remember things at the right moment. That's the experience that we want.

Q Any privacy scares when you're handling such a huge volume of user data? And what all challenges did you face?

Zeesha: Evernote always puts our user's privacy ahead of everything else. As a developer – knowing the challenges in machine learning, data mining – the more data you have the better it is, and the more you can do with it helps you create a better experience. Having said that, when we at the AI team deal with data while implementing algorithms, we never cross user data boundaries. All our algorithms work only in the context of a single user data. This makes developing applications very hard. So we at Evernote don't have a single data problem, but 100 million small data problems. For e.g. how do you develop a word processor for a user who has English and Chinese notes? These are some of the challenges that we deal with that most people don't know about. Dealing with data and making our algorithms scale for users irrespective of whether they have 10 notes or thousands of notes is one of our biggest challenges. 